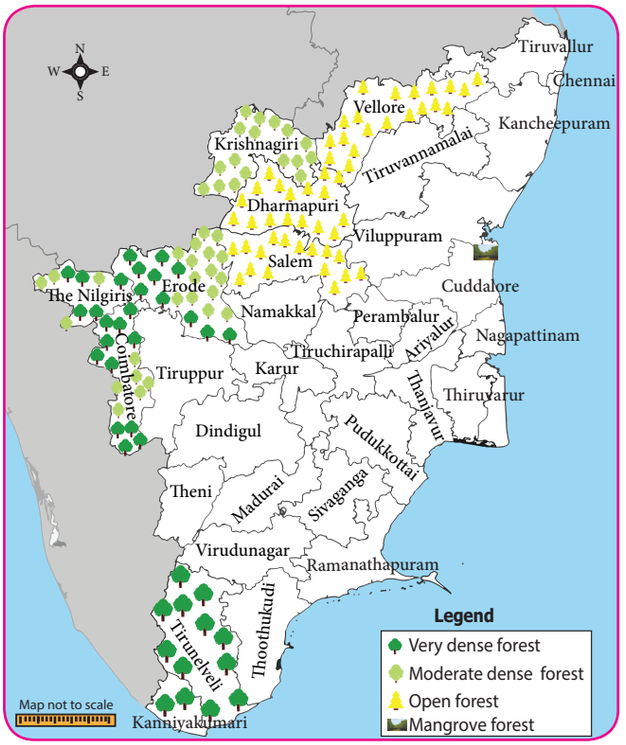
Forests

There are many types of forests across Tamil Nadu. Most of these forests are found in the areas near the ghats. These forests have so many types of trees. The topmost branches of the trees form a continuous chain such that little or no sunlight hits the ground, this is called canopy. The forests are divided based on the canopy cover:

Very Dense Forest	The Nilgiris, Coimbatore, Tirunelveli, Erode,
Moderate Dense Forest	The Nilgiris, Coimbatore, Erode, Krishnagiri
Open Forest	Salem, Vellore, Dharmapuri



Forests in Tamil Nadu

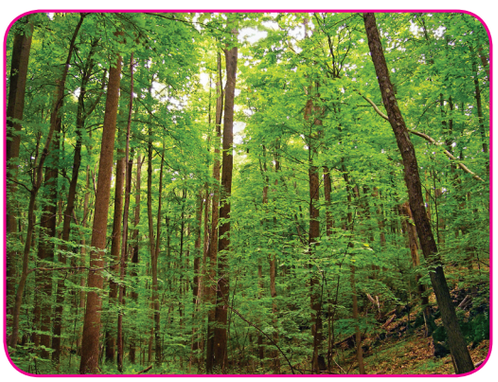
The forests can also be grouped as:

a) Evergreen forests:

The word evergreen means:

Ever (always) + green = Always green

The trees in these forests have leaves that are always green. In Tamil Nadu we find evergreen forests in the Western ghats of Tirunelveli, Kanniyakumari, The Nilgiris and Coimbatore.



Deciduous forest

b) Deciduous forests:

The trees in these forests shed their leaves during the dry season.

These forests are usually found near the evergreen forests. They generally grow in the lower regions of the hills.

c) Swamp (Mangrove) forests:

The word swamp means areas that are low where water gets collected easily. These forests are usually found near the beaches and river beds.



Mangrove forest

The Pichavaram mangrove forest is located near Chidambaram in Tamil Nadu.

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